

TROGONS

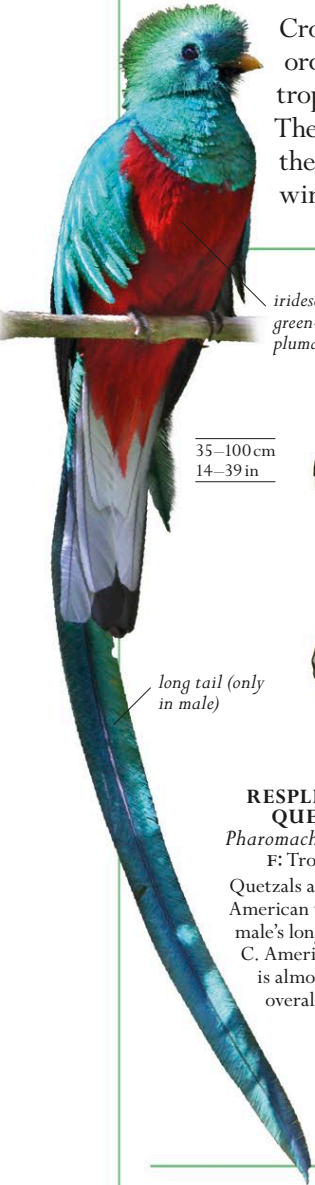
Gaudily coloured birds of tropical forests, the fruit-eating trogons have a wide bill, delicate plumage, and a foot structure unique to this group.

Crow-sized birds belonging to the order Trogoniformes are found in tropical America, Africa, and Asia. The males have brighter plumage than the females. Long-tailed and short-winged, trogons are capable fliers,

though reluctant to break cover. The first and second toes of a trogon's foot face backwards whereas the third and fourth toes face forwards. This arrangement is seen in no other birds. These unusual feet are so weak that a trogon can barely manage more than a shuffle when perched.

Trogons use their wide bill for tackling large fruit and taking invertebrates such as caterpillars. They also use their bill for excavating nesting holes in rotten wood and termite mounds.

PHYLUM	CHORDATA
CLASS	AVES
ORDER	TROGONIFORMES
FAMILIES	1
SPECIES	43



35–100 cm
14–39 in

iridescent green-blue plumage

long tail (only in male)

RESPLENDENT QUETZAL
Pharomachrus mocinno
F: Trogonidae

Quetzals are iridescent American trogons. The male's long tail in this C. American species is almost half its overall length.



31–36 cm
12–14 in

RED-HEADED TROGON
Harpactes erythrocephalus
F: Trogonidae

An Asian trogon found from the Himalayas to Sumatra, this elusive bird, like many of its cousins, perches motionless for long periods.



27–32 cm
10½–12½ in

ORANGE-BREASTED TROGON
Harpactes oreskios
F: Trogonidae

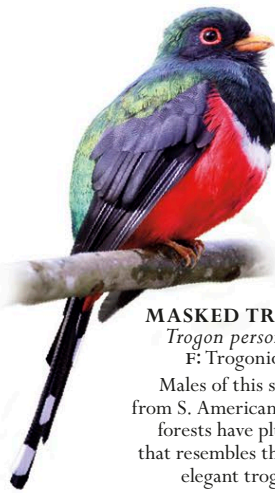
The colour pattern of this bird, dull upperparts, and bright underparts, is typical of many Asian trogons. This species is a native of S.E. Asia.



28–30 cm
11–12 in

ELEGANT TROGON
Trogon elegans
F: Trogonidae

The only trogon with a range that extends to the USA, this bird occurs in montane forests from southern Arizona to C. America.



25–27 cm
10–10½ in

MASKED TROGON
Trogon personatus
F: Trogonidae

Males of this species from S. American montane forests have plumage that resembles that of the elegant trogon.



26–28 cm
10–11 in

CUBAN TROGON
Priotelus temnurus
F: Trogonidae

One of two species of *Priotelus* trogons confined to the Caribbean, this is the national bird of Cuba.

jagged-tipped tail

MOUSEBIRDS

Named for their scurrying, rodent-like behaviour, the mousebirds are a small group of drab-coloured, long-tailed birds confined to sub-Saharan Africa.

Mousebirds, the sole family of the order Coliiformes, are softly feathered in shades of brown or grey and have an erectile crest and long tail. Gregarious and agile, they resemble parakeets in behaviour. These tree-dwelling birds build twiggy, cup-shaped nests. The chicks hatch at an advanced stage of development and quickly master flight. Ornithologists think that mousebirds are the remnant of a more diverse group that, in prehistoric times, ranged beyond Africa. Fossil mousebirds have been found in Europe. Their relationship to other birds is uncertain: mousebirds could be allied with trogons, kingfishers, or woodpeckers.

PHYLUM	CHORDATA
CLASS	AVES
ORDER	COLIIFORMES
FAMILIES	1
SPECIES	6

SPECKLED MOUSEBIRD
Colius striatus
F: Coliidae

The largest and one of the most widespread of mousebirds, this species occurs from Nigeria to South Africa in savanna and open woodland.



30–35 cm
12–14 in

33–35 cm
13–14 in

BLUE-NAPED MOUSEBIRD
Urocolius macrourus
F: Coliidae

Urocolius mousebirds are stronger fliers and less "mouse-like" than *Colius* mousebirds. This scrubland dweller is found from Senegal to Tanzania.

